ON THE BOIL

- **The Karnataka Caste Census report 2024 recommends reservation for state's OBCs raised from 32% to 51%. This will take total quotas to 85% (including 24% for SC/STs and 10% for EWS groups)**
- **Dominant OBC groups, Veerashaiva-Lingayats and Vokkaligas, say the survey was 'unscientific', claim undercounting of their populations**
- **They fear their political clout will weaken; 16 of Karnataka's 23 CMs have been from these two communities. The 33-member cabinet has 13 Lingayats and Vokkaligas**
- **The assigning of the most backward 'I-b' slot to Kurubas raises eyebrows. CM Siddaramaiah, who commissioned the survey in 2015, is a Kuruba, while Deputy CM Shivakumar is a Vokkaliga**

of Bihar and methodologically more comprehensive, to see the light of day. The report gives a detailed break-up of the caste composition of Karnataka's population and, based on a weighted assessment of socio-economic, educational and employment parameters, recommends a hike in reservation quota for the Backward Classes, a demographic segment now confirmed as accounting for about 70 per cent.

The survey was commissioned in 2014, a year into Siddaramaiah's first term in office, and remains the first such door-to-door survey conducted by Karnataka since 1984. (The Union government's own 2011 Socio-Economic and Caste Census famously stayed under wraps.) Prior to that, the only caste-based demographic data had come from the 1931 all-India census, which had included a caste count. A decade behind the veil, the KSES 2015 report has always been a political minefield. Once made

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